Humana. **Claims Payment Policy**

Subject: Laboratory – Testing for Vector-Borne Infections

Application: Medicare Advantage Products
Policy number: LAB2023053
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Medicare Advantage Payment Policy

As a Medicare Advantage plan, we have developed payment policies to explain coverage more fully for services. The criteria outlined will apply to Medicare Advantage plans except when the procedure(s) has established criteria through the Original Medicare Local Coverage Determinations (LCD's) as outlined below.

In addition to this policy, claims payments are subject to other plan requirements for the processing and payment of claims, including, but not limited to, requirements of medical necessity and reasonableness and applicable referral or authorization requirements.

Babesiosis

1. To detect Babesia microti, Nucleic Acid Amplification Tests (NAAT) testing, including Polymerase Chain Reaction (PCR) testing, (CPT code 87469) **IS REIMBURSABLE** for individuals with one of the following symptoms:

    - Body aches
    - Chills
    - Fatigue
    - Fever
    - Hemolytic anemia
    - Hepatomegaly
    - Insect bite
    - Jaundice
    - Splenomegaly
    - Weakness

2. For individuals with a diagnosis of Babesiosis, the use of either an Immunoglobulin G (IgG) or Immunoglobulin M (IgM) indirect immunofluorescence antibody (IFA) assay (CPT code 86753) for Babesia **IS NOT REIMBURSABLE**.

Borrelia

1. To detect Borrelia spp., NAAT testing, including PCR testing, (CPT code 87478), an IFA assay for Immunoglobulin G (IgG) antibodies (CPT code 86619) or detection by immunoblot of Immunoglobulin G (IgG) or Immunoglobulin M (IgM) antibody (CPT code 0043U, CPT code 0044U) **IS REIMBURSABLE** for individuals with one of the following symptoms:

- Arthralgia
- Chills
- Headache
- Insect bite
- Myalgia
- Nausea
- Vomiting

Dengue Virus

1. For individuals with a diagnosis of classical or hemorrhagic dengue fever, the hemagglutination inhibition test (CPT code 86280) **IS NOT REIMBURSABLE.**

Ehrlichiosis and Anaplasmosis

1. To detect Anaplamsa phagocytophilum or Ehrlichia chaffeensis, NAAT testing, including PCR testing, of whole blood (CPT code 87468, CPT code 87484) or an IFA assay for Immunoglobulin G (IgG) antibodies (CPT code 86666) **IS REIMBURSABLE** for individuals with one of the following symptoms:

    - Fever
    - Gastrointestinal issues, including nausea, vomiting and diarrhea
    - Headache
    - Insect bite
    - Malaise
    - Myalgia
    - Shaking chills

Plasmodium (Malaria)

1. The use of an IFA assay for Plasmodium antibodies (CPT code 86750) **IS NOT REIMBURSABLE.**

Rickettsiosis

1. The use of an IFA assay for Immunoglobulin G (IgG) antibodies to Rickettsia (CPT code 86757) **IS REIMBURSABLE** twice when at least two weeks has passed between tests and **IS ONLY REIMBURSABLE** for individuals with any of the following symptoms:

    - Abdominal pain
    - Anorexia
    - Chills
    - Fever
    - Headache
    - Insect bite
    - Malaise
    - Myalgia
    - Nausea
    - Photophobia
    - Skin rash
    - Ulcerative lesion with regional lymphadenopathy for Rickettsia species 364D rickettsiosis
    - Vomiting

2. For individuals with a diagnosis of typhus fever or Rickettsiosis, blood culture testing (CPT code 87040) **IS NOT REIMBURSABLE.**

West Nile Virus

1. The use of an IFA assay for Immunoglobulin M (IgM) antibodies specific to West Nile virus (CPT code 86788, CPT code 86789) **IS REIMBURSABLE** for individuals with any of the following symptoms:

    - Abdominal pain
    - Altered level of consciousness
    - Arthralgia
    - Fatigue
    - Fever
    - Headache
    - Insect bite
    - Maculopapular rash
    - Myalgia
    - Nausea
    - Neck stiffness
    - Vision loss
    - Vomiting
    - Weakness

2. For individuals with a diagnosis of West Nile virus infection, the use of an IFA assay for Immunoglobulin G (IgG) antibodies specific to West Nile virus (CPT code 86789) **IS NOT REIMBURSABLE.**

Zika Virus

1. NAAT testing including, PCR testing, (CPT code 87662*) or Immunoglobulin M (IgM) testing (CPT code 86794*) for Zika virus **IS REIMBURSABLE** for individuals with any of the following symptoms:
    - Abnormal brain development
    - Conjunctivitis
    - Decreased joint movement
    - Feeding problems
    - Fever
    - Headache
    - Hearing loss
    - Joint pain
    - Microcephaly
    - Muscle pain or stiffness
    - Rash
    - Seizures
    - Suspected exposure to Zika virus
    - Ultrasound findings consistent with congenital Zika virus
    - Vision problems

General

1. For asymptomatic individuals, testing for Babesiosis, Borrelia, Dengue virus, Ehrlichiosis and Anaplasmosis, Plasmodium, Rickettsiosis, West Nile virus or Zika virus with the tests discussed above **IS NOT REIMBURSABLE.**

Applicable procedures for Medicare Advantage plans

Procedure Code	Code Description
86280	Hemagglutination inhibition test (HAI)
86619	Antibody; Borrelia (relapsing fever)
86666	Antibody; Ehrlichia
86750	Antibody; Plasmodium (malaria)
86753	Antibody; protozoa, not elsewhere specified
86757	Antibody; Rickettsia
86788	Antibody; West Nile virus, IgM
86789	Antibody; West Nile virus
86794*	Antibody; Zika virus, IgM
87040	Culture, bacterial; blood, aerobic, with isolation and presumptive identification of isolates (includes anaerobic culture, if appropriate)
87468	Infectious agent detection by nucleic acid (DNA or RNA); Anaplasma phagocytophilum, amplified probe technique
87469	Infectious agent detection by nucleic acid (DNA or RNA); Babesia microti, amplified probe technique
87478	Infectious agent detection by nucleic acid (DNA or RNA); Borrelia miyamotoi, amplified probe technique
87484	Infectious agent detection by nucleic acid (DNA or RNA); Ehrlichia chaffeensis, amplified probe technique
87662*	Infectious agent detection by nucleic acid (DNA or RNA); Zika virus, amplified probe technique
0043U	Tick-borne relapsing fever Borrelia group, antibody detection to 4 recombinant protein groups, by immunoblot, IgM Proprietary test: Tick-Borne Relapsing Fever Borrelia (TBRF) ImmunoBlots IgM Test Lab/Manufacturer: IGeneX Inc
0044U	Tick-borne relapsing fever Borrelia group, antibody detection to 4 recombinant protein groups, by immunoblot, IgG Proprietary test: Tick-Borne Relapsing Fever Borrelia (TBRF) ImmunoBlots IgG Test Lab/Manufacturer: IGeneX Inc

**The payment criterion for CPT code 86794, CPT code 87662 apply to all Medicare jurisdictions, except those states awarded to Noridian Healthcare Solutions, LLC.*

Original Medicare Local Coverage Determinations (LCDs)

Contractor Name	Policy Title	Policy Number	Procedure Code
Noridian Healthcare Solutions, LLC	Billing and Coding: Zika Virus Testing by PCR and ELISA Methods	A55326	86794 87662
Noridian Healthcare Solutions, LLC	Billing and Coding: Zika Virus Testing by PCR and ELISA Methods	A55327	86794 87662

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